

CANDY DIALOGUE ENGINE

History UI Customization

1.0.0

The History UI displays dialogue history. It's a very simple and open-ended UI to customize.

The History UI scene can be used to display either the general history log (which contains history from all dialogue engine instances, if you use multiple), or a specific engine instance's history log.

The History UI scene can be a child of an engine instance scene (e.g. Candy_UI), or it can be located anywhere (you can use the same History UI for all engine instances and for the general history log if you want).

Just make sure that each engine instance points correctly to the History UI you want it to use in its **ui_elements_paths** variable, in **Candy_Engine.gd** under the "PATHS" region.

For general history, provide the path to the History UI in **history_ui** in the **open_general_history()** function in **Candy_Functions.gd**:

```
var history_ui = get_node("")
```

Nodes

Root

The root node can be named anything you want. For displaying the history of engine instances, just make sure to update the path to the History UI scene in **ui_elements_paths**, in **Candy_Engine.gd** under the "PATHS" region.

Required Nodes

The following nodes are required:

History Display

- Must be a RichTextLabel node.
- Displays the dialogue history log.
- Script pointer: @onready var **log_node**

Script

Base

The script **History_Display.gd** should be attached to the scene's root node.

Variables

Required:

default_z

The default z_index value for the History UI scene.

caller

The dialogue engine instance that the History UI is meant to work with. For general history, the **open_general_history()** function (**Candy_Functions.gd**) sets this to 'null' . You normally don't need to modify the value in any way, unless you've made unusual changes to the code.

Functions

show_history()

Makes the History UI visible and calls **update_history_display()**.

Called by **open_instance_history()** or **open_general_history()** in **Candy_Functions.gd**.

update_history_display()

This function fetches the appropriate history log from an engine instance's **dialogue_history** or from **candy_de.general_dialogue_history**, formats it, then makes the **log_node** display it as text.

close_history()

Technically optional, but you'll probably want a function that closes the History UI, unless your game is designed such that this logic is handled elsewhere.

In the default History UI scene, the 'Close' button calls this function when clicked. Depending on your needs, you might trigger the function in other ways (e.g. moving mouse or clicking outside the History UI, pressing the 'Escape' key, timer countdown, etc.).

Further Customization

As you probably noticed, the default History UI scene and the associated code are very basic. You can of course get far more creative, and add nodes or code to your History UI to achieve all kinds of designs, purposes and behaviors.